CONTRACTOR SUPPORT OF U.S. OPERATIONS IN THE USCENTCOM AREA OF RESPONSIBILITY

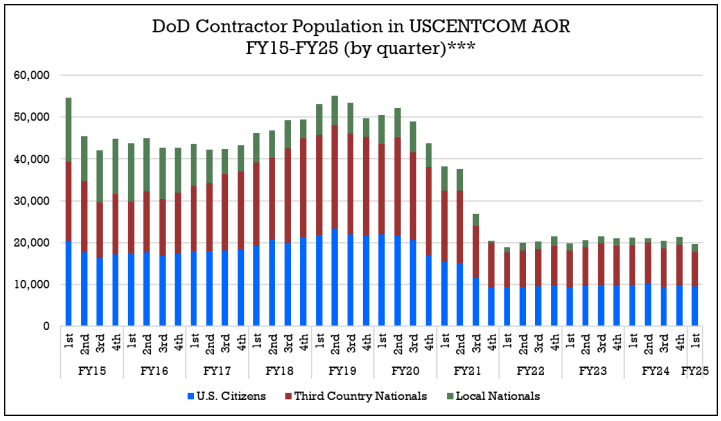
BACKGROUND: This report provides Department of Defense (DoD) contractor personnel numbers for 1st quarter Fiscal Year 2025 (FY25) and the current status of efforts underway to improve management of contractors accompanying United States (U.S.) Forces. It includes data on DoD contractor personnel deployed in Iraq and Syria, Operation Inherent Resolve (OIR), and the U.S. Central Command (USCENTCOM) area of responsibility (AOR). During FY25, the Department will conduct a review and develop an updated plan for future reports.

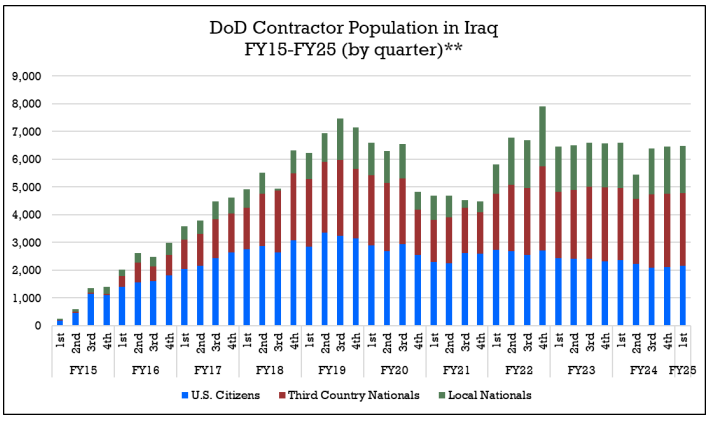
KEY POINTS: During 1st quarter FY25, USCENTCOM reported approximately 19,671 contractor personnel supporting DoD in the USCENTCOM AOR, a decrease of approximately 1,670 from the previous quarter.

DoD Contractor Personnel in the USCENTCOM AOR

	Total Contractors	U.S. Citizens	Third Country Nationals (TCN)	Local Nationals
Iraq and Syria	6,474	2,151	2,625	1,698
Other USCENTCOM Locations	13,197	7,396	5,709	92
USCENTCOM AOR	19,671	9,547	8,334	1,790

DoD Contractor Population Trends (FY15–FY25)*





* To maintain a 10-year quarterly view of contractor populations, the date range has been changed to reflect FY15-FY25 data.

** Information on the contractor population in Syria was incorporated starting 2nd quarter FY18.

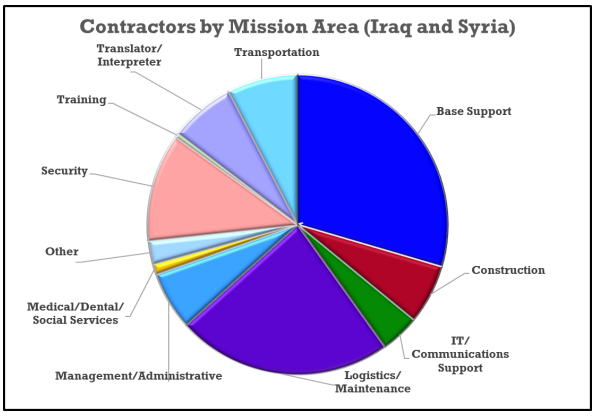
*** Information on the contractor population in Israel is included in the USCENTCOM AOR totals starting in 4th quarter FY21.

Prepared by: ODASD(Log) January 2025

OIR (Iraq and Syria) Summary

- The distribution of contractors in Iraq and Syria by mission category are:

Base Support	1,911	29.5%
Construction	414	6.4%
IT/Communications Support	272	4.2%
Logistics/Maintenance	1,504	23.3%
Management/Administrative	407	6.3%
Medical/Dental/Social Services	74	1.1%
Other	164	2.6%
Security	753	11.6%
Training	28	0.4%
Translator/Interpreter	453	7.0%
Transportation	494	7.6%
Total:	6,474	



  - Contractor Posture: Approximately 6,474 DoD contractors directly supported DoD-funded contracts in Iraq and Syria. This is an increase of 0.37% from 4th quarter FY24.

- **USCENTCOM Operational Contract Support (OCS):**
  - **Combined Joint Task Force - Operation INHERENT RESOLVE (CJTF-OIR) Operational Contract Support Integration Cell (OCSIC)**:
    - During this quarter, the CJTF-OIR OCSIC undertook a series of site visits to conduct initial assessments in support of the relocation of OIR personnel and equipment. The OCSIC team identified requirements for base life support and communication equipment and collaborated with the Department of State to develop a comprehensive Statement of Work in conjunction with an interagency agreement.
    - Additionally, the OCSIC played a critical role in supporting the Rehearsal of Concept (ROC) drill conducted with the 1st Theater Sustainment Command. This exercise focused on planned base closures and the OCSIC's expertise was instrumental in informing and shaping the concept of operations. By providing OCS expertise, the OCSIC helped ensure a comprehensive and effective plan for the closure of bases, which is a key component of the OIR drawdown strategy. The OCSIC'S contributions to the ROC drill demonstrated their ability to provide critical support to operational planning efforts and underscored the importance of their role in enabling the success of CJTF-OIR operations. The OCSIC also established new standard operating procedures to enhance collaboration with key stakeholders. Specifically, the team developed different recurring touchpoints with contracting offices, to include the 408th Contracting Support Brigade, Defense Logistics Agency, and Task Force Guardian.

IMPROVEMENTS TO MANAGEMENT AND OVERSIGHT OF DOD CONTRACTORS

- **Office of the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics (ODASD(Log)):**
  - **OCS Governance and Oversight**. On November 20, 2024, the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics and the Vice Director for Logistics, Joint Staff (JS J4) co-chaired the 1st quarter FY25 OCS Functional Capabilities Integration Board (FCIB) meeting. The meeting included an update from U.S. European Command on its recent OCS planning

collaboration with NATO allies. The Navy provided two briefings including one on the Navy's future operating concept, Distributed Maritime Operations, and an update on the use of the Worldwide Expeditionary Multiple Award Contract (WEXMAC). Other OCS FCIB presentations included updates on the Global Market Research Initiative and Synchronized Predeployment Operational Tracker-Enterprise Suite funding. The next meeting will be held on February 26, 2025.

- The revised Department of Defense Instruction 3020.41, *Operational Contract Support Outside the United States,* was approved by the Under Secretary of Defense for Acquisition and Sustainment on November 27, 2024. The revised instruction can be found online at https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodi/302041p.pdf.

- **OCS Joint Capability Improvement Working Group (CIWG) Update**. On October 24, 2024, the CIWG convened to discuss initiatives underway to improve OCS capability and integrate commercial support to operations into policies and processes, as well as planning and execution of operations. The U.S. Marine Corps requested the CIWG endorse closure of their action to improve OCS planning through implementing commercial capability category management to aid in OCS planning of commonly contracted commodities and services. The CIWG endorsed the closure request, and the action was formally closed by the OCS FCIB prior to the November 20, 2024, OCS FCIB meeting. The next CIWG meeting will be held on January 23, 2025.

- **Defense Standards for Security Services:**

  - All DoD contracts for private security services require compliance with American National Standard Institute (ANSI) PSC.1-2012 (R2017), "Quality Management Standard for Private Security Company Operations" or International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 18788-2015 "Management Systems for Private Security Operations." All private security companies contracted by DoD at any tier are currently compliant with one or both of the existing standards and have achieved independent third-party certification.

  - The DoD continues to review timelines for companies to transition to the revised standard, ANSI/ASIS PSC.1-2022 "Management System for Private Security Company Operations—Requirements with Guidance."

  - A total of 96 private security companies from 34 different countries have achieved independent third-party certification to one or both standards. The decrease from the 4th quarter report is partially attributable to reporting changes from one of the certification bodies.

- **JS J45, Operational Contract Support Division (OCSD):**

  - **Assessments and Reporting.** J45 OCSD conducted the FY24 Joint Assessment on Commercial Capabilities and initiated planning for FY25 commercial assessments.

  - **Individual Training.**

    - **Joint OCS Planning and Execution Course (JOPEC**). During the 1st quarter FY25, J45 OCSD trained 65 students through two remote-learning JOPEC offerings, hosted by U.S. Forces Korea and U.S. Northern Command.

- **Joint Enabling Capabilities Command (JECC), Joint Planning Support Element (JPSE), Joint Enhanced Training (JET).** J45 OCSD facilitated JET events for 104 JPSE planners and mentors at the JECC on November 21-24, 2024, focusing on rapidly establishing a joint task force headquarters for a humanitarian assistance and disaster relief response and helping participants gain a greater understanding of essential OCS tasks to plan for and manage commercial capabilities.
- **Joint Knowledge Online (JKO).** J45 OCSD continues to develop a four-phase suite of training to replace the current Joint OCS Essentials for Commanders and Staff suite. The first two phases are available to students on the JKO platform:
  - OCS I, *Leveraging Commercial Capabilities Across the Competition Continuum*. A total of 4,039 students have completed OCS I to date.
  - OCS II, *OCS Fundamentals*. A total of 1,255 students have completed OCS II to date.
- **Joint Logistics Course (JLC), Army Sustainment University (ASU).** J45 OCSD delivered OCS instruction at two sessions of the JLC, on November 4 and December 4, 2024, respectively, to a total of 75 attendees.
- **Joint Logistics Planning Course (JLPC) Pilot, ASU.** J45 OCSD participated in the December 2024 pilot for the planned JLPC, to further refine commercial capability considerations and OCS concepts and procedures in the proposed course curriculum. The JLPC will equip graduates with the required strategic and operational knowledge and tools to effectively plan logistics support in interagency, inter-organizational, and multinational operations.
- **U.S. Space Force (USSF) Joint Professional Military Education (JPME) Assessment.** J45 OCSD participated in the USSF's JPME assessment on November 4-7, 2024. The assessment evaluated the extent to which the USSF's curriculum addressed OCS and commercial capabilities in accordance with U.S. Law and DoD policy.
- **U.S. Air Force Advanced Logistics Readiness Officer Course (ALROC).** J45 OCSD instructed 15 ALROC students on OCS and the strategic and operational planning considerations for commercial capabilities on October 2-3, 2024. The instruction reinforced the processes and structures in place to gain understanding of the operational environment, including how to access commercial markets in times of crisis.
- **Joint Engineer Operations Course (JEOC), U.S. Army Engineer School.** J45 OCSD delivered a presentation on leveraging commercial capabilities through OCS to 57 operational engineers attending the JEOC on December 10, 2024.

- **OCS in Exercises**. J45 OCSD instructed 180 Defense Contract Management Agency (DCMA) servicemembers and civilians on OCS operational planning considerations for integrating commercial capabilities into military operations as part of DCMA's annual Joint Tabletop Exercise, conducted on October 24-25, 2024.